

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

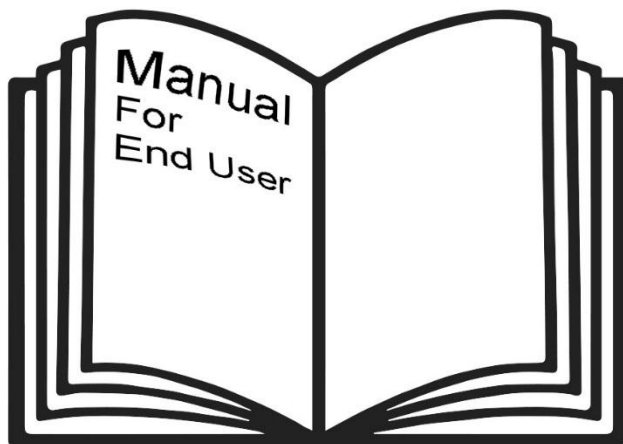
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Let's Start!

Developing a Manual for End-users



Learning Outcome:

Understand key information about the concepts, principles, and methodologies in simple spoken and written situations. Talk about programming techniques, use cases, kinds, and sequences in simple spoken and written situations.

Ask your partner:

- What do you think the purpose of creating an end-user manual is?
- What is the difference between an end-user and a support staff manual?

Can Do Statements:

- I can talk about the documentation of program code.
- I can explain what documentation program code is.
- I can understand different related information about documentation of program code.





Let's Explore!

What is Software Documentation about?



Instructions: Read the text below.

Alex: Hey Sara, how are you?

Sara: I'm doing well. I'm reading about documentation of program code. But there are some things that I still don't understand.

Alex: I studied that last semester. I didn't think it was very hard. I can go over everything you need to know about this topic if you want.

Sara: If you don't mind taking some time to help me, it'll be great.

Alex: No problem. When we refer to computer system documentation, there are two main categories everyone has to keep in mind. Depending on the type of audience, we can have manuals and training material for someone that doesn't know much about software or programming. And on the other hand, we can have documentation of program code for programmers.

Sara: I didn't know there were two categories. I thought users and software developers used similar manuals.

Alex: Not everyone understands how programming code works, so it's important to have a simpler version of software instructions. Imagine somebody that doesn't know about software trying to understand the same instructions programmers use. Now, in software documentation, there are comments that describe how a line or section of code works.

Sara: So a program doesn't execute only the code but also its comments?

Alex: No. The compiler ignores comments and pays attention to the code only. So comments don't interfere with the program execution. You also need to know that programmers don't only use commented source code but also external documentation. A software developer that is working with a program, sometimes needs to understand the program's purpose, structure and operations. This is why, programs usually include more detailed information than only comments on the code.

Sara: In the article I am reading, it says that including documentation became important in the 1970s and software developers kept writing more detailed documentation as programs became harder to develop and more difficult to maintain.

Alex: Thank you for explaining all this, it was very interesting.





Let's Practice!

Alex shares some information about documentation of program code.

Instructions: Read the sentences. Write the missing word(s) in the blank. Use: Something important, something, understand anything, anything about. Practice saying the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. There is _____ called external documentation related to the program code.
2. _____ to highlight, is the design of flowcharts and outlines when talking about external documentation.
3. I don't know _____ documentation of program code, but I hear that documentation is an important part of software engineering.
4. I didn't _____ about the technical aspect of documentation of code, but I remember it outlines detailed information of the software.



Let's Practice!

Paul talks to Alex about the documentation of program code.

Instructions: Organize the mystery sentence. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. manuals for / don't know / There are / much about software. / users that

2. program code / and users' manuals. / difference between / understand the /
documentation of / Alex didn't

3. only use / Programmers don't / external documentation. / but also / commented
source code

4. know that / that explain / having comments / so helpful. / code were / I didn't



Extension Activity

Now it's your turn to find more information the documentation of program code.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Find more information about the benefits of implementing documentation of program code.
- Choose the most important ideas.
- Organize the information in a poster.
- Explain the benefits of implementing documentation of program code to your partners.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

- I find information about the documentation of program code.
- I choose the most important ideas.
- I organize the information in a poster.
- I explain the benefits of implementing documentation of program code to your partners.

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Target Words

- **audience** (noun): a group of people that are expected to acquire a product
e.g. Depending on the type of audience, we can have manuals and training material for someone that doesn't know much about software or programming.
- **pay attention** (verb): to show interest in something and keep oneself informed on the topic
e.g. The compiler ignores comments and pays attention to the code only.
- **compiler** (noun): the computer program that transforms code from programming to machine language
e.g.. The compiler ignores comments and pays attention to the code only.
- **interfere** (verb): to come in the way or interrupt a process
e.g. Comments don't interfere with the program execution.
- **commented source code** (expression): a code which has comments that explain how it works or its purpose
e.g. You also need to know that programmers don't only use commented source code but also external documentation.
- **execution** (noun): the process of running a code
e.g. Comments don't interfere with the program execution.



Learning Points

Indefinite Pronouns

We use suffixes like **-body**, **-one**, **-thing** and **-where** to refer to people, places and things in a general way.

Indefinite pronouns refer to an unspecific person, place, or thing. They are formed with a quantifier or distributive and a suffix. As quantifiers, we can use *any*, *some*, *every* and *no*.

SOME: We use it in affirmative sentences to indicate a small quantity.

EVERY: We use it to indicate the participation of all the elements of a group.

NO: We use it to indicate absence.

Let's take a look at the following chart of **indefinite pronouns**:

	Person	Place	Thing
All	everyone everybody	everywhere	everything
Part (positive)	someone somebody	somewhere	something
Part (negative)	anyone anybody	anywhere	anything
None	no one nobody	nowhere	nothing

Examples

- *There are two main categories everyone has to keep in mind.*
- *We can have manuals and training material for someone that doesn't know much about software or programming.*
- *I can go over everything you need to know about this topic if you want.*





Learning Points

Auxiliary + Not Contractions

We can use an auxiliary verb followed by the particle '**not**' to express a negative sentence.

In English language, we use **contractions** when a conversation or a text is not formal. We have to keep in mind that for the **simple present** and **simple past** tenses we are only going to use an auxiliary verb when the main verb of the sentence is different from the verb **to be**. The auxiliary verb we use is **to do** which we need to conjugate depending on the tense and the subject of the sentence. Let's take a look at the following examples:

Simple Present

*I'm **not** familiar with documentation of program code.*
*She **doesn't** know much about how software programming works.*
*They **don't** want to hire new workers for the I.T. team.*

Simple Past

*I **wasn't** familiar with documentation of program code.*
*She **didn't** know much about how software programming works.*
*They **didn't** want to hire new workers for the I.T. team.*

Note that the conjugation of the auxiliary verb in **simple past** is always the same for all subjects.

Examples

- *There are some things that I still don't understand.*
- *Depending on the type of audience, we can have manuals and training material for someone that doesn't know much about software or programming.*
- *I didn't know there were two categories. I thought users and software developers used similar manuals.*